

## **1. Introduction**

To establish the nature of this project, this report begins with a summary of what FilmPulse was and an outline of the structure. Hence, this report includes three sections: the first section describes and analyzes my decisions and contributions, the second section evaluates the outcomes and dynamics of our team, and the third section features a critical reflection on what I learned. Starting with the summary, FilmPulse was a group project in the creative industries, specifically film, which was aimed at supporting filmmakers in York who were just beginning their careers. The project evolved into a marketing service and short film festival event that provided a public platform to showcase independent films, but also practical online marketing support. Our initiative was grounded in a research-led strategy and in establishing a strong digital presence, which allowed for the fruition of the Kaleidoscope Film Festival; something we are all proud of in our group.

## **2. Contribution and Role**

### **2.1 Role Overview**

In FilmPulse, my role primarily consisted of Marketing and Content Creation, with core responsibilities ranging from setting up the website's domain, drafting and designing the site, and maintaining and updating it to reflect our evolving identity and messaging, among others. Next, I worked closely with the Marketing Director on the marketing strategy, utilizing the STP model and Marketing Mix framework to create various forms of digital content, such as the website, digital assets (logos, photographs, etc.), and some custom graphics in the presentation, primarily in my section (Baines, Rosengren and Antonetti, 2022). Surprisingly, this proved to be a serendipitous role, aligning with many of my interests and skills. By and large, I believe that my effort helped support FilmPulse's core values of accessibility and visibility by solidifying the project's digital presence.

### **2.2 Contribution Breakdown**

#### *Initial Phase (Weeks 1-2)*

In the early parts of this group project, my team took part in the timetabled supervisor meetings but also organized additional brainstorming sessions, which helped us realize that pivoting to an online marketing education platform and film festival event would be more effective toward our goal and also more realistic given our resources. I, personally, started a discussion to understand what a potential website platform could look like, deciding on aspects like the structure, apart from the visuals.

#### *Mid Phase (Weeks 3-7)*

Firstly, I quickly set up paid subscriptions with both the domain and website providers. I researched cost-effective services that were still very robust. Ultimately, I decided on PorkBun, an American domain registration company with positive reviews and fair prices, and Wix for the website hosting and creation, which, despite being more expensive than alternative options like WordPress, was more modern and reliable in my eyes. I proceeded with designing the layout, navigation, and user interface of the website, ensuring that it was presented appropriately on mobile devices, which is a challenge on its own, as it involves

meticulously adjusting all webpages on the site by hand. I, then, populated the site with promotional content like news updates, filmmaker bios, festival schedules, and others, most of which required weekly or even daily updating throughout.

### *Final Phase (Weeks 8-10)*

Undeniably, this phase was the most crucial and stressful of all. Our team had to juggle two major components: the running of our business endeavors (updating our digital presence on social media and our website, communicating with clients, organizing the event, etc.), along with the creation and rehearsal of a presentation to showcase our hard work to the examiners.

In terms of the former, I made sure that the website was always up to date with real-time festival day logistics, social media links, and digital flyers that were kindly provided by our team's invaluable Social Media Manager and Content Creator. In addition, Kaleidoscope Film Festival took place during this period, and I assisted with some in-person logistics, including ushering guests and managing post-event digital documentation (coordination of behind-the-scenes video file transfers during post-production).

As for the latter, the presentation, I was in charge of the Marketing Strategy, ensuring it was all based on relevant marketing theory that we were taught last year in the course (Baines et al., 2022). In conjunction with the theory, I utilized reliable secondary sources to interpret data from sources like the Los Angeles Film School (2023) and the University of York curriculum audits (2024a), which all contributed to the segmentation, targeting, and positioning (STP) process and visualization of our target market's demographic. In this section, I also referenced the UK Higher Education marketing gaps, discovering a lack of integrated marketing education in film courses, all of which helped us understand our audience further and draft the festival's marketing message. Lastly, I contributed significantly to the design and compilation of our group presentation, involving frequent meetings that allowed us to refine the slides, brand tone, and integration of our event.

## **2.3 Rationale Behind Decisions**

This sub-section explains and justifies the choices behind the key decisions that I, personally, made and outlined in the above segment. For instance, I chose the STP model to aid in understanding and defining our core market (early-career filmmakers with limited access to marketing training based in York) and, ultimately, tailoring our outreach efforts accordingly (Baines et al., 2022). Furthermore, the Extended Marketing Mix frameworks (the 7Ps of Marketing) helped anchor our marketing in the real world, promoting on multiple platforms (Instagram, TikTok, Web), prioritizing accessibility, and offering free entry to the event (Baines et al., 2022; GOV.UK, n.d.). Moreover, the website included minimal jargon, a clean and easy-to-navigate UI, and a warm, mentor-like tone throughout, which reflected our emphasis on the element of community. Lastly, real-world benefits such as education, visibility, and community, were clearly showcased on the site; in hopes of bridging the gap left by lackluster academic film courses (York St John University, 2025; Breven, 2023).

### **3. Evaluation and Outcomes**

#### **3.1 Team Achievements**

In the end, our efforts paid off. We managed to successfully deliver a pleasant short film festival that addressed a gap in film marketing (lack of exposure and support). I was happy to hear that the feedback on our event and website from participating attendees and filmmakers was overwhelmingly positive (FilmPulse Audience Survey, 2025; FilmPulse Client Survey, 2025). Also, our digital marketing efforts drove significant traffic to the site and generated high engagement, which is all attributed to our Social Media Manager and Content Creator, once again. She mentioned that this success was due to audience-specific captions, strategic content, and careful timing, which I do not doubt. However, I, personally, also think that her impeccable and unique design skills with Canva (a digital design & editing software) were even more essential to this.

#### **3.2 Personal Achievements**

I took advantage of professional-grade website tools to create a landing page for displaying what FilmPulse was about; something I had never attempted before, at least not involving a site of such scale and live domain from scratch. As was mentioned, I frequently maintained and updated the website with fresh content and communicated with my team to ensure relevance and consistency. Furthermore, the value proposition segment in the marketing strategy required data-driven insights (graduation rates and gaps in marketing education), which I contributed to by discussing, researching, and presenting. I also assumed numerous creative and technical roles to collaborate with my team, from footage management to website design and digital content uploads.

#### **3.3 Areas for Improvement**

Truthfully, the website would benefit from more interactive and social elements for users. These could take the form of comment sections, real-time Q&As, and, possibly, even forum discussions, all of which could have improved the community interaction aspect of our brand. Additionally, our client and audience post-event surveys were created in a rushed manner and were not adequately thought out by a team member who rarely showed his face and, unfortunately, did not show up for the presentation. Also, it would be ideal if we had clarified and communicated our business's nature earlier, so that there would be no need to switch from a direct marketing agency to an event and online marketing education provider, which also, possibly, hindered our external messaging.

#### **3.4 Team Dynamics**

Elaborating on the team member who was disengaged throughout the project and absent from our presentation, we were forced to make a few last-minute changes that involved redistributing tasks and, in turn, taking on additional load. In spite of this, we understand that this individual might have been facing extenuating circumstances and are, in no way, judging him for his limited engagement.

To illustrate, I took on the responsibility of reviewing the post-event client and audience questionnaires on Google Forms, analyzing the data for insights, and creating dedicated slides in the presentation, which

included neat graphics that visualized these findings. Still, we remained calm and maintained our supportive communication via messaging apps and shared documents. Hence, our effective collaboration efforts allowed for shorter turnaround times and let us make decisions quickly.

## **4. Reflection and Learning**

### **4.1 Personal Development**

This was a novel, valuable, and educational journey for me. I learned the fundamentals of website development, such as design principles that aid user accessibility and hosting/domain name logistics. Apart from that, I became more familiar with marketing strategy, revisiting theories from some of my favorite modules from the course, and applying models like STP and the 7Ps to guide communications was an exciting and unprecedented experience for me, as it was done in a real, practical setting. What is more, I improved my overall research-to-application translation skills, such as when I informed our outreach tone and strategy based on educational statistics from academic sources. Lastly, I felt more confident in taking charge, especially in group discussions, when I needed to become more proactive in discussing our branding decisions and digital presence.

### **4.2 Challenges**

Several minor challenges came about throughout this project, such as handling additional tasks because of one member's absence, as I mentioned before, which added immense pressure in the final weeks. Moreover, in order to maintain a consistent tone across all of our digital channels, strong collaboration and communication between team members were needed, which proved to be difficult at times. What I found distinctly challenging was keeping a delicate balance between technical tasks and creative ones. This is because I am an intrinsically creative person and was naturally inclined to spend more time on the creative tasks as opposed to the technical ones, which tested my time management and, ultimately, even improved it.

### **4.3 Lessons Learned**

Transitioning to the key lessons that I was taught through overcoming the aforementioned challenges, there are mainly three to count. I understood that to create a functional website that functions as both an accessible information hub and a brand showcase for us, there needed to be an emphasis on user-focused design. In other words, putting the user first and thinking like them, making things as easy as possible. Next, I realized the significance of audience insights that should ground strategy, and how data-driven planning and analysis make a noticeable difference. In addition, it became apparent how cohesion can be easily hindered by gaps in communication, and how important it is for stakeholder alignment to have early clarity in such projects.

### **4.4 Future Considerations**

If I am ever lucky enough to take part in such an amazing project again as a website designer and marketer, I wish to enhance my skills in UX/UI design, possibly by attending workshops, watching YouTube tutorials, or through paid online courses. Specifically, I would like to learn more about interactive web elements such as live social feeds, collapsible info sections, and embedded videos, which I purposely avoided at times in

this project because they frightened me due to their complexity. However, this is an important component that I aim to master since it improves real-time engagement from users. On a broader level, I hope to pursue roles that allow me to explore strategy along with digital design (the technical and the creative). I would, possibly, explore the non-profit side of the creative industries and maybe focus more on film, as this project helped me discover my love for this kind of work. Finally, I am certain that I want to collaborate with people on such projects again. Projects that place a heavy emphasis on the interdisciplinary aspects, blending storytelling, tech, and design together, all of which are intriguing to me.

## **5. Conclusion**

FilmPulse blended elements of theory, collaboration, and creativity in a way that I had never experienced before, and proved to be a formative experience for me on a personal level. I learned to apply marketing theory through specific frameworks in various contexts, as well as helping put together a live event that had a meaningful local impact, mainly through the development and maintenance of our digital infrastructure.

Overall, I became a person with expanded technical know-how, improved strategic and marketing thinking, and further cemented my love for the creative industries and the arts, more specifically, the digital communication aspects. I was made aware of how teamwork and adaptability can turn challenges into growth opportunities. I can confidently say that these skills I will carry with me into future projects and professional roles.

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## Appendices

### A. Weekly Activity Log

#### Week 1–2:

- Participated in concept brainstorming.
- Helped define the project pivot and reviewed York’s film landscape for gaps.

#### Week 3–4:

- Purchased a domain and configured web hosting.
- Designed the initial homepage layout using mobile-first logic.

#### Week 5–6:

- Populated site with bios, schedule drafts, and launch content.
- Co-wrote slides for marketing pitch using Baines et al. (2022) and institutional reports.

#### Week 7–8:

- Updated the website weekly with new promotional info.
- Created image blocks and buttons for smoother navigation.

#### Week 9–10:

- Handled event-day updates and tech file transfers.
- Assisted in rehearsals and presentation packaging.

### B. Artifacts Produced

- **FilmPulse Website:** Live screenshots and navigational breakdowns.
- **Marketing Strategy Slide Drafts:** Annotated PowerPoint files.
- **STP and Market Gap Notes:** Based on LFS (2019), BFI (2023), and internal research.
- **Hosting Setup Documentation:** Screenshots and backend logs.
- **Festival Schedule Files:** Word and PDF versions uploaded to website.

### C. Reflective Summary Table

| Skill Area         | Before Project            | After Project                             | Future Step                                |
|--------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Digital Marketing  | Basic familiarity         | Applied STP/7Ps in a live event           | Apply in arts-focused digital campaigns    |
| Website Creation   | Never launched a domain   | Designed and ran full promotional site    | Learn deeper UX/UI principles              |
| Strategic Planning | Conceptual awareness      | Delivered pitch grounded in industry data | Use in writing/festival planning           |
| Communication      | Informal, ad hoc          | Led tone-setting across website           | Refine stakeholder management skills       |
| Technical Support  | No prior event experience | Managed post-event media logistics        | Develop editing/data backup skills further |